

JESSENE LEE

University of Toronto
Department of Political Science

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EDUCATION

University of Toronto

Ph.D. Candidate, Political Science, *Ongoing*
Fields: International Relations, Comparative Politics

National University of Singapore

Master of Social Sciences, Political Science, 2022
Bachelor of Social Sciences, Political Science, 2018

ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS

Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore

Young NUS Fellow, 2024-2026

Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore

Research Affiliate, 2022 -

PUBLICATIONS

Books

2026 Outsourcing Surveillance: Online Opinion Management in China. **Cambridge University Press**. With Lynette H. Ong and Huihua Nie.

Peer-reviewed Articles

2025 Contesting the Liberal Script? The AIIB and the World Bank in Development Finance. **International Affairs** 101, no. 5 (September 2025): 1655-1677. With Soo Yeon Kim.

Book Chapters

2024 Emerging Divergence: Distinct Data Regulatory Models Around the World. In *Data Governance and the Digital Economy in Asia: Harmonizing Cross-Border Data Flows*, edited by Paul Cheung, Liu Jingting and Ulrike Sengtschmid. **Routledge**.

WORKING PAPERS

7. "Caught in the Network: Can Countries Diversify AI Investments Amid Asymmetric Dependence?", with Yan Bowen
6. Influential Intermediaries: Firms and the Implementation of Environmental and Social Standards in International Organizations.

5. Rescripting the Liberal Order? The AIIB and the Politics of Infrastructure Finance. With Soo Yeon Kim.
4. Hierarchy in Complexity: PTAs and the Regime Complex in Intellectual Property Rights. With Manfred Elsig, Soo Yeon Kim and Andrew Lugg.
3. Connecting Regimes: Preferential Trade Agreements and the Management of the Intellectual Property Rights Regime. With Manfred Elsig, Soo Yeon Kim and Andrew Lugg. (*R&R at Review of International Political Economy*)
2. Glass Ceilings, Glass Walls, and Glass Cliffs: Gender Bias in the Leadership of International Organizations. With Phillip Lipsky and Taylor Jackson.
1. Membership and its Benefits: Vote Shares and Voting Power in the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank. With Soo Yeon Kim.

POLICY ARTICLES (SELECTED)

3. RCEP's Moment to Matter. *Lowy Institute*. May 28, 2026. [PDF]
2. ASEAN's Window of Opportunity for Shaping Global Data Governance. *The Diplomat*. September 15, 2023. [PDF]
1. Data Regulation through Trade Agreements: Assessing the Emergence of Distinct Regulatory Regimes. *Asia Competitiveness Institute Research Paper Series*.

MEDIA / OPEDS (SELECTED)

4. Like Hong Kong, Singapore Proves Itself a Vital 'Superconnector' Economy. *South China Morning Post*. June 10, 2026. With Jingting Liu. [PDF]
3. Flexible Multilateralism for a World in Flux. *The Business Times*. February 10, 2026. With Paul Cheung. [PDF]
2. The Lasting Impact of FTAs Amid Global Trade Shocks. *The Business Times*. July 18, 2025. With Paul Cheung. [PDF] [Additional coverage (1) (2)]
1. Another Digital Trade Deal, What's the Big Deal? *The Business Times*. August 8, 2024. [PDF]

CONFERENCE AND PAPER PRESENTATIONS

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| 2026 | American Political Science Association, Annual Meeting, Washington DC
International Studies Association, Annual Convention, Columbus |
| 2025 | Freie Universität Berlin Cluster of Excellence 'Contestations of the Liberal Script in Regional Organizations in the Global South and the Global North' Authors' Conference, Berlin
Annual Political Networks and Computational Social Science Conference and Workshops, Boston
American Political Science Association, Annual Meeting, Vancouver
Pacific International Politics Conference, Waseda University, Tokyo |

- ‘Individuals in International Policy’ Workshop, LBJ School of Public Affairs, The University of Texas at Austin
- International Studies Association, Annual Convention, Chicago
- The Political Economy of International Organization, Annual Conference, Harvard University, Boston
- 2024 International Political Economy Society Conference, European University Institute, Florence, Italy
- American Political Science Association, Annual Meeting, Vancouver
- Pacific International Politics Conference, Korea University, Seoul
- Political Networks Conference, Florida State University
- Workshop on ‘Contemporary Challenges to Trade and Trade Policy’, University of Salzburg
- International Studies Association, Annual Convention, San Francisco
- Data and Policy Analytics Seminar Series, Asia Competitiveness Institute, Lee Kuan Yew School of Public Policy, National University of Singapore
- Freie Universität Berlin Cluster of Excellence ‘Contestations of the Liberal Script’ Session on East Asia, Berlin
- 2023 American Political Science Association, Annual Meeting, Los Angeles
- ‘Asia in International Financial Affairs’ Workshop, Goethe University Frankfurt
- Pacific International Politics Conference, National University of Singapore
- Midwest Political Science Association, Annual Conference, Chicago
- International Studies Association, Annual Convention, Montreal, Canada
- 2022 Freie Universität Berlin Cluster of Excellence “Contestations of the Liberal Scripts” Regional Conference: Liberal Script(s) — Asian Versions and Contestations of a Concept, Berlin
- 2021 Singapore Political Economy Seminar, ESSEC Business School, Singapore
- 2020 The Political Economy of International Organization, Annual Conference, Vancouver

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

- 2025 American Political Science Association (APSA) International Collaboration Section Travel Grant
- 2025 American Political Science Association (APSA) Graduate Student Support Member Grant
- 2024 - 2026 National University of Singapore Development Grant
- 2023 - 2025 Singapore Social Science Research Council Graduate Research Fellowship
- 2024 International Studies Association (ISA) Travel Grant
- 2023 American Political Science Association (APSA) First Generation Scholar Travel Grant
- 2023 - 2025 University of Toronto Department Conference Travel Awards
- 2021 - University of Toronto Fellowship
- 2021 University of Toronto Department of Political Science Graduate Program Recruitment Award

Teaching Awards

2021 National University of Singapore Graduate Students' Teaching Award (2 of 2 eligible semesters)

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Aug 2021 -	Research Assistant For Professor Phillip Lipsky Department of Political Science, University of Toronto
Aug 2021 - Dec 2024	Research Assistant For Professor Soo Yeon Kim Department of Political Science, National University of Singapore
Aug 2018 - Aug 2020	Teaching Fellow Department of Political Science, National University of Singapore
Jan 2018 - Dec 2018	Research Assistant Center for Social Development Asia, Singapore
Jan 2018 - Dec 2018	Research Assistant Asia Center for Social Entrepreneurship and Philanthropy, Singapore
Jan 2017 - Dec 2017	Research Assistant For Professor Sung Eun Kim Department of Political Science, National University of Singapore
Jan 2016 - Dec 2016	Research Assistant Housing Development Board, Singapore
Jan 2016 - Dec 2016	Research Assistant Ministry of Social and Family Development, Singapore

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Toronto, Teaching Assistant

2026	Global Political Economy (for Louis Pauly)
2025, 2024, 2023, 2022	Introduction to Quantitative Reasoning (for Kenichi Ariga, Olga Chyzh)
2025, 2023	Scarcity, Sustainability, and the Future of International Relations (for Mark Nieman)
2024, 2023, 2022	Statistics for Political Scientists (Graduate-level course, for Olga Chyzh, Michael J. Donnelly, Daniel Rubenson)
2024	Qualitative Methods (for Linda White)
2022, 2021	Introduction to International Relations (for Seva Gunitsky)

National University of Singapore, Teaching Fellow

Awarded Graduate Students' Teaching Award

2021, 2020, 2019	International Political Economy (for Soo Yeon Kim)
2021	Political Inquiry (for Chonghyun Choi)
2020, 2019	Chinese Politics (for Chen An)
2020	Public Administration in Singapore (for Shamsul Haque)
2020	Women and Politics (for Dunya Lepori)
2020	Origins of the Modern World (for Sinja Graf)
2019	Southeast Asian Politics (for Deepak Nair)
2019	International Security (for Chong Ja Ian)
2019, 2018	Introduction to Politics (for Terence Lee)
2018	Global Issues (for Josh Kurz)

SERVICE

Reviewer

International Studies Quarterly
Journal of Southeast Asian Economies
Review of International Organizations
World Development
World Trade Review

Service to the University

2025 - 2026	Co-convener, Inaugural Quantitative Methods Research Cluster Conference, University of Toronto
2023 - 2026	Co-convener, Quantitative Methods Research Cluster, University of Toronto
2022	Judge, Singapore Undergraduate Policy Conference, National University of Singapore
2022	Instructor, Introduction to Data Analysis and Visualization in R Short Course, National University of Singapore
2020 - 2021	Founding Head, Political Science Graduate Student Conference, National University of Singapore

Service to the International Graduate Student Community

2021 - 2023	Editor-in-Chief, International Association of Political Science Students Journal
2021	Co-Chair, Yale European Studies Graduate Fellows Conference, Yale University
2018	Deputy Head, International Association of Political Science (IAPSS) Students Academic Convention

EXTRA TRAINING

- 2023 **IPSA-NUS Methods School**
Causal Mediation Analysis, Experimental Method
- 2019 **ECPR Methods School**
Time Series Analysis, Causal Analysis based on Observational Data, Quantitative Text Analysis, Advanced Regression Analysis
- IPSA-NUS Methods School**
Network Analysis

SKILLS

R, Python, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Git/Github, English (native), Mandarin Chinese (native), Japanese (reading proficiency), Korean (reading proficiency), Sign Language (SEE)